

Rent the traffic. Own the list.

How to start a list with zero subscribers, and the welcome sequence that turns a new signup into someone who trusts you, while you sleep.

01

Start from zero

02

What a lead magnet does

03

The welcome sequence

01

How to start a list from nothing

Every platform you build on is rented. Your email list is the only audience you own, and no algorithm can take it. Start it now, while it's small.

Pick a platform

YOU NEED

One email platform to hold your list

NOT

A perfect setup first

Make one freebie

YOU NEED

One small lead magnet

IT SOLVES

One narrow problem

Add a form

PUT IT

Where people already find you

LIKE

Your articles and pins

Start writing

WRITE TO

Whoever subscribes

HOWEVER FEW

The list grows from the habit

Why waiting is backwards: the list is how you build the audience you keep. Twelve people you started this month beat zero you'll start "once you're bigger." The second one never starts.

02

What a lead magnet actually needs to do

A lead magnet is a small free resource someone gets in exchange for their email. Its only job is to solve one narrow problem completely. Beginners over-build this. A 40-page ebook is often worse, not better.

One problem

Narrow enough to solve completely in a page or two.

One win

They finish with a result, not just information.

One reason to stay

Good enough that email two gets opened.

One piece of you

A slice of what you already teach: one template, one checklist, step one.

Smaller wins: one sharp, complete solution beats a sprawling one that solves nothing fully. It also shows exactly what more you offer.

Your lead magnet is ready when:

- ☐ It solves one small problem, start to finish
- ☐ Someone can use it in a page or two
- ☐ She finishes it with a result in hand
- ☐ She thinks "that was genuinely useful"

Your social content is how people find you. Your list is how you keep them.

03

The welcome sequence outline

A welcome sequence is a short series of automated emails a new subscriber gets after signing up. You write it once. Every future subscriber gets it in her most engaged moment, right after she raised her hand.

- 1 **Deliver the promise.** Send the freebie that got her in, and make it easy to find.
- 2 **Introduce yourself.** Who you are and why this inbox is worth opening.
- 3 **Share one thing you figured out** that she hasn't yet.
- 4 **Tell a short story with a point,** or make one honest recommendation, no strings.
- 5 **Ask one question** you actually want answered. None of it has to sell a thing.

Why it matters most: it reaches people at peak attention. No email you send later will be opened as reliably. Write it like it's the only one that counts, because it nearly is.

AFTER THE WELCOME

Send one genuinely useful email a week → keep it to a rhythm you can hold for a year → ask for nothing while you're building trust → sell rarely, specifically, and only when it's right → and the list keeps opening.

The ratio matters more than the pitch: a list that hears from you usefully most of the time will happily buy when you ask. A list that only hears from you when you're selling learns to stop opening.